

ICC RANKING: **4th**

**BEST WC PERFORMANCE
CHAMPION (2000)**

STRENGTHS

Amelia Kerr has been New Zealand's standout, carrying batting and bowling workloads with 927 runs and 23 wickets in the 2022-25 cycle. Alongside Sophie Devine and Suzie Bates, her all-round prowess anchors the team's balance. Jess Kerr's steady seam adds reliability, while Brooke Halliday and Maddy Green strengthen the middle order.

WEAKNESSES

The White Ferns' ODI form has slumped sharply — from a 61% win rate in 2014-17 to 37.5% this ICC Women's Championship (2022/25) cycle. Familiar batting issues persist, with over-reliance on Devine and Bates and instability in the opening and No. 3 slots. A six-month break since their last series against Sri Lanka in March leaves the squad under-prepared.

OPPORTUNITIES

The World Cup is a chance to accelerate transition. Flora Devonshire's call-up, along with Polly Inglis, Bella James, and Bree Illing, injects new energy. Amelia Kerr's adaptability up the order signals a fresh approach, while experimenting with young openers like Georgia Plimmer offers scope to discover long-term successors to the Devine-Bates partnership.

THREATS

The looming retirement of Devine and the advancing years of Bates could leave a leadership and batting vacuum too soon. Inexperience in high-pressure contests, coupled with limited recent international exposure, heightens vulnerability. Indian conditions may magnify these gaps, especially if the newer faces struggle to adjust quickly against stronger, more settled opposition.

PREDICTION

New Zealand's mix of veterans and emerging all-rounders, anchored by Amelia Kerr's form, offers hope. If experience and youth align, a semifinal return is possible

Kavita Menon

**CAPTAIN
SOPHIE DEVINE**

**COACH
BEN SAWYER**

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